

**LA TROBE UNIVERSITY — MELBOURNE CAMPUS***Master RAG Knowledge Base*

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## 23. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS — CURRENT STUDENTS

Source: [latrobe-current.custhelp.com](http://latrobe-current.custhelp.com) | Contact ASK La Trobe: 1300 528 762

### 23.1 Orientation & Getting Ready

**Q: Do I need to attend Orientation?**

A: Yes — strongly recommended for all students. International students **MUST** attend the compulsory International Orientation. Orientation includes in-person, online and on-demand events, workshops, social events, and club sign-ups. Classes begin in Week 1 — the week after Orientation.

**Q: How do I get my Student ID card?**

A: Three steps: (1) Take an approved photo. (2) Fill out the online form via StudentOnLine and upload your photo. (3) Allow 5 working days — you will receive an email when your card is ready to collect from the campus pickup location.

**Q: What is my Student ID card used for?**

A: Identifying you as a La Trobe student; borrowing from the library; printing and photocopying; accessing approved buildings; confirming identity at exams; and receiving student discounts.

**Q: What if my Student ID card is lost or stolen?**

A: Email lost-stolen cards with your full name and student ID number. Your card will be cancelled and you can then order a replacement.

### 23.2 Enrolment

**Q: How do I enrol in subjects?**

A: Log into StudentOnLine. Select your Major/Minor/Specialisation if applicable, then search for and add your subjects. First-year students typically enrol in first-year level subjects only.

**Q: What is AWOL?**

A: AWOL means you are registered as a La Trobe student but have let your course lapse by not enrolling in subjects or taking official leave. Contact ASK La Trobe immediately if you receive an AWOL notification.

**Q: What is the difference between Deferral and Leave of Absence?**

A: Deferral is for new students who have not yet completed a subject or passed Census Date and want to pause before starting. Leave of Absence (LOA) is for current/continuing students who want to pause their studies.

**Q: Can international students study online subjects?**

A: Yes, with conditions. International students on student visas must enrol in at least one face-to-face or blended subject in each compulsory study period. Contact ASK La Trobe for your specific situation.

## 23.3 Fees & Financial Support

### Q: How do I pay my fees?

A: All payments must be made through the Online Payment Portal. Payment methods: BPAY, credit card (Mastercard/VISA), or HELP loan deferral. No payments accepted at ASK La Trobe Help Zones.

### Q: What is a Census Date?

A: The last day to: withdraw from a subject without financial and academic penalty; submit HELP loan forms and eCAF. La Trobe does not allow extensions or payment plans after Census Date.

### Q: My fees show as 'Unpaid' after deferring to HECS-HELP — is this normal?

A: Yes. Fees deferred via a HELP loan show as 'Unpaid' or 'Overdue' in StudentOnLine until the University reports them to the ATO. This is completely normal.

### Q: What happens if I have overdue fees?

A: A sanction is placed on your account restricting: LMS access, class attendance, exam eligibility, results access, and graduation. Clear all debts to remove sanctions.

## 23.4 Results & Academic Progress

### Q: How do I appeal a result?

A: Contact your subject coordinator via email first. If still unsatisfied, apply for a formal Review of Marks via StudentOnLine within the required timeframe. Provide a valid reason — not just 'I needed more marks to pass'.

### Q: What happens if I reach Stage 2 of academic progress?

A: You must attend an Academic Recovery Workshop (register via the Academic Progress LMS site). You may have conditions placed on your enrolment. You can appeal within 20 working days of your Stage 2 email.

### Q: What is a Conceded Pass?

A: If you score 47-49% in a subject, you may be automatically granted a Conceded Pass (NC). It appears on your transcript and counts as a pass but the actual grade remains NC.

## 23.5 International Students

### Q: What is a Confirmation of Enrolment (CoE)?

A: The official document issued by the University confirming your enrolment, required for your student visa. You must complete your studies within your CoE timeframe.

### Q: How do I extend my student visa?

A: Steps: (1) Obtain an Agreed Progression Plan (APP). (2) Update contact details in StudentOnLine. (3) Extend your OSHC policy. (4) Get new Financial Guarantee Letter if sponsored. (5) Apply for a new CoE (up to 7 working days — issued only after current semester results are released). (6) Apply to extend your visa with the Department of Home Affairs.

### Q: What is the minimum study load on a student visa?

A: Semester-based: 4 subjects (60 credit points) per compulsory semester. Term-based: 2 subjects (30 credit points) per compulsory term. Reducing below this requires formal approval via StudentOnLine.

## 23.6 Support Services

### **Q: Where do I go if I'm struggling mentally or emotionally?**

A: Contact La Trobe Counselling & Mental Health at Peribolos East (PE) Level 2. For after-hours support (24/7), call 1300 146 307 or text 0488 884 100. For emergencies, call Campus Security on (03) 9479 2222 or 000.

### **Q: Where can I get help with my studies?**

A: Visit the Library (ASK La Trobe Help Zone, Level 1), The Learning Commons (TLC), or book a session with a Peer Learning Advisor (PLA). For subject-specific help, contact your lecturer or tutor via email.

### **Q: I received a sanction — what does this mean?**

A: Sanctions restrict access to university services. They can result from overdue fees, incomplete AIM, overdue library items, or academic progress issues. Resolve the underlying issue and contact ASK La Trobe.